

Answers

Answer all Submit on or before 9<sup>th</sup> of June 2023.

1. Let  $\rho = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 & 8 & 9 & 10 \\ 3 & 5 & 4 & 6 & 9 & 7 & 1 & 8 & 10 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$  be a permutation in  $S_{10}$ .

- (i). Express  $\rho$  as a product of transpositions.
- (ii). What are the orders of  $\rho^{-1}$  and  $\rho^4$ ?
- (iii). List the  $\rho$  – orbits and  $\rho^3$  – orbits.

2. (a). Prove that the order of a permutation is the least common multiple of its disjoint cycles.

(b). Let  $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 3 & 6 & 5 & 4 & 1 & 2 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\beta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 3 & 7 & 4 & 2 & 1 & 6 & 5 \end{pmatrix}$  be permutations in  $S_7$ .

- (i). Write  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  as products of transpositions.
- (ii). Find the order of  $\alpha\beta$ .
- (iii). Find a cycle  $\sigma$  in  $S_7$  such that  $\alpha^2\sigma = \beta^3$ .

3. Let  $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 3 & 6 & 5 & 4 & 1 & 2 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\beta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 6 & 5 & 3 & 4 & 7 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$  be permutations in  $S_7$ .

- (i). What are the orders of  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ?
- (ii). Find  $\alpha^{-1}$ ,  $\alpha\beta\alpha^{-1}$  and  $\alpha^{40}$ .
- (iii). Find  $\gamma$  in  $S_7$  such that  $\gamma\alpha = \alpha\beta$ .

4. Let  $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 5 & 6 & 1 & 4 & 3 & 2 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\beta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 6 & 4 & 3 & 5 & 7 & 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$  be permutations in  $S_7$ .

- (i). Find  $\alpha^{-1}$  and  $(\alpha\beta)^{50}$ .
- (ii). Write  $\alpha^2\beta^{-2}$  as a product of two disjoint 3-cycles.
- (iii). Find  $\gamma$  in  $S_7$  such that  $\gamma^2\alpha = \beta$ .

5. Let  $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 2 & 3 & 4 & 1 & 6 & 7 & 5 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\beta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 7 & 6 & 5 & 1 & 3 & 4 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$  be permutations in  $S_7$ .

- (i) Write  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  as products of disjoint cycles and calculate their orders.
- (ii). Find  $\alpha\beta$ ,  $\beta^{-1}$ ,  $\alpha\beta\alpha^{-1}\beta^{-1}$  and  $\beta^{25}$ .
- (iii). Find non-trivial permutation  $\rho$  in  $S_7$  such that  $\alpha\beta\rho\beta^{-1}\alpha^{-1} = \rho$

6. Let  $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 3 & 6 & 5 & 4 & 1 & 2 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\beta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 6 & 5 & 3 & 7 & 2 & 1 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$  be permutations in  $S_7$ .

- (i). Write  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  as products of disjoint cycles and calculate their orders.
- (iii). Find non-trivial permutation  $\rho$  in  $S_7$  such that  $\alpha^{-2}\beta^{-2}\rho\beta^2\alpha^2 = \rho$ .

7. (a). Prove that an even permutation in  $S_5$  can be written as a product of 4-cycles.

(b). Let  $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 & 8 \\ 2 & 3 & 1 & 5 & 4 & 7 & 8 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\beta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 & 8 \\ 7 & 3 & 4 & 2 & 6 & 5 & 8 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$  be permutations in  $S_8$ .

- (i). Find a permutation  $\rho (\neq \omega, \alpha\beta, (\alpha\beta)^{-1})$  in  $S_8$  such that  $\alpha^{-1}\beta^{-1}\rho\beta\alpha = \rho$ .
- (ii). Find a cycle  $\sigma$  in  $S_8$  such that  $\sigma\alpha^4\sigma^{-1} = \beta^2$ .

8. Let  $\alpha = (1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)(6 \ 8 \ 7)$  and  $\beta = (1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 2)(5 \ 6 \ 8 \ 7)$  be permutations in  $S_8$ .

- (i). Find  $\alpha^{-1}$  and  $(\alpha\beta)^{25}$ .
- (ii). What are the orders of  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ?
- (iii). Find  $\rho$  in  $S_8$  such that  $\rho\beta\rho^{-1} = \beta^3$

$$(1) (i) P = (1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)(2 \ 5 \ 9 \ 10)$$

This can be written as a product of transpositions,

$$P = (1 \ 3)(1 \ 4)(1 \ 6)(1 \ 7)(2 \ 5)(2 \ 9)(2 \ 10)$$

$$(ii) P^{-1} = (7 \ 6 \ 4 \ 3 \ 1)(10 \ 9 \ 5 \ 2)$$

$$\text{Order of } P^{-1} = 5 \times 4 = 20$$

$$P^4 = [(1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)(2 \ 5 \ 9 \ 10)]^4$$

$$= (1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)^4 \underbrace{(2 \ 5 \ 9 \ 10)^4}_{=1}$$

$$= (1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)(1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)(1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)(1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)$$

$$P^4 = (1 \ 7 \ 6 \ 4 \ 3) //$$

(iii) 
$$p = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 & 8 & 9 & 10 \\ 3 & 5 & 4 & 6 & 9 & 7 & 1 & 8 & 10 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 6 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 1 \\ 2 \rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 9 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow 2 \\ 8 \rightarrow 8 \end{array} \right\} \begin{array}{l} \text{orbit 1} \\ \text{orbit 2} \\ \text{orbit 3} \end{array}$$

1<sup>st</sup> orbit  $B_1 \Rightarrow (1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)$

2<sup>nd</sup> orbit  $B_2 \Rightarrow (2 \ 5 \ 9 \ 10)$

3<sup>rd</sup> orbit  $B_3 \Rightarrow (8)$

$p \in S_{10}$  has 3 orbits  $= \{B_1, B_2, B_3\}$

$$= (1 \ 3 \ 4 \ 6 \ 7)(2 \ 5 \ 9 \ 10)(8)$$

$$P^3 = \left[ (1\ 3\ 4\ 6\ 7)(2\ 5\ 9\ 10) \right] \left[ (1\ 3\ 4\ 6\ 7)(2\ 5\ 9\ 10) \right] \\ \left[ (1\ 3\ 4\ 6\ 7)(2\ 5\ 9\ 10) \right]$$

$$P^3 = (1\ 6\ 3\ 7\ 4)(2\ 10\ 9\ 5)(8)$$

$$\text{Orbit } 1 = (1\ 6\ 3\ 7\ 4)$$

$$\text{orbit } 2 = (2\ 10\ 9\ 5)$$

$$\text{orbit } 3 = (8)$$

(2) Order of a cycle =

(a) length of the cycle

Let  $\alpha, \beta$  are two cycles  
of length  $m$  and  $n$ .

$$\alpha^m = E, \beta^n = E, E\text{-identity}$$

Then  $k$  can be consider  
as  $k = l, m$

$$\alpha^k = \alpha^{l_1 m} = (\alpha^m)^{l_1}$$

$$= (E)^{l_1} = E$$

$$A \vee_0 = l_2^n \Rightarrow \beta^k = \beta^{l_2^n}$$

$$= (\beta^n)^{l_2} = E^{l_2} = E$$

$$\text{Since } \alpha\beta = \beta\alpha$$

$$\begin{aligned} (\alpha\beta)^k &= \alpha^k \beta^k = E \cdot E \\ &= E \end{aligned}$$

$\alpha\beta$  become identity,  
it's not necessary to  
be  $k$  is the order of  
 $\alpha\beta$ .

Let  $t$  is the order of  
 $\alpha, \beta$ .

$$(\alpha\beta)^t = E$$

$$\alpha^t \cdot \beta^t = E$$



$$\alpha^t = \beta^{-t}$$

$\alpha = \beta$  or have

common entities.

But  $\alpha, \beta$  are disjoint

$\therefore \alpha, \beta$  are identities

But  $m$  and  $n$  divides  $t$ .

$$t = k.$$

$\therefore$  Order of disjoint cycles is the least common multiplication of their lengths.

(b)(i)

$$\alpha = (1\ 3\ 5)(2\ 6) = (1\ 5)(1\ 3)(2\ 6)$$

$$\beta = (1\ 3\ 4\ 2\ 7\ 5) = (1\ 5)(1\ 7)(1\ 2)(1\ 4)(1\ 3)$$

$$(ii) \quad \alpha\beta = (1\ 3\ 5)(2\ 6)(1\ 3\ 4\ 2\ 7\ 5) \\ = (1\ 5\ 3\ 4\ 6\ 2\ 7)$$

Order of  $\alpha\beta = 7$

$$(iii) \quad \alpha^2 = (1\ 3\ 5)^2(2\ 6)^2 = (1\ 3\ 5)(1\ 3\ 5) \\ \alpha^2 = (1\ 5\ 3)$$

$$\beta^3 = (1\ 3\ 4\ 2\ 7\ 5)(1\ 3\ 4\ 2\ 7\ 5)(1\ 3\ 4\ 2\ 7\ 5)$$

$$\beta^3 = (1\ 2)(3\ 7)(4\ 5)$$

$$\alpha^2\sigma = \beta^3$$

$$\therefore \sigma = \alpha^{-2} \beta^3$$

$$= (3 \ 5 \ 1)(1 \ 2 \ 3 \ 7)(4 \ 5)$$

$$\sigma = (1 \ 2 \ 3 \ 7 \ 5 \ 4) //$$

(3)

$$(i) \alpha = (1 \ 3 \ 5)(2 \ 6)$$

$$\text{order} = 3 \times 2 = 6$$

$$\beta = (2 \ 5 \ 7)(1 \ 6)$$

$$\text{order} = 3 \times 2 = 6$$

(ii)

$$\alpha = (1 \ 3 \ 5)(2 \ 6)$$

$$\alpha \beta \alpha^{-1} = (1 \ 3 \ 5)(2 \ 6)(2 \ 5 \ 7)(1 \ 6)(5 \ 3 \ 1)(6 \ 2)$$

$$= (1 \ 7 \ 6)(2 \ 3)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 \alpha^{40} &= \alpha^{6 \times 6 + 4} \\
 &= \left( [(1 \ 7 \ 6)(2 \ 3)]^6 \right)^4 [(1 \ 7 \ 6)(2 \ 3)]^4 \\
 &= [(1 \ 7 \ 6)(2 \ 3)]^4 \\
 &= [(1 \ 7 \ 6)^4 (2 \ 3)^2]^2 \\
 &= [(1 \ 7 \ 6)]^4 \\
 &= [(1 \ 7 \ 6)^3 (1 \ 7 \ 6)] \\
 &= [(1 \ 7 \ 6)] //
 \end{aligned}$$

$$(iii) \quad \gamma \alpha = \alpha \beta$$

$$\gamma = \alpha \beta \alpha^{-1}$$

$$= [(1 \ 7 \ 6)(2 \ 3)] //$$

$$(4) \quad (i) \quad \alpha = (1 \ 5 \ 3)(2 \ 6)$$

$$\therefore \alpha^{-1} = (3 \ 5 \ 1)(6 \ 2)$$

$$\beta = (1 \ 6 \ 2 \ 4 \ 5 \ 7)$$

$$\therefore \beta^{-1} = (7 \ 5 \ 4 \ 2 \ 6 \ 1)$$

$$\alpha\beta = (1 \ 5 \ 3)(2 \ 6)(1 \ 6 \ 2 \ 4 \ 5 \ 7)$$

$$\Rightarrow (1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)(5 \ 7)$$

$$(\alpha\beta)^{S_0} = (\alpha\beta)^{8 \times 6 + 2}$$

$$= \left( \left[ (1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)(5 \ 7) \right]^8 \right)^6 \left[ (1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)(5 \ 7) \right]^2$$

$$= (1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)^2 (5 \ 7)^2$$

$$= (1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)(1 \ 2 \ 4 \ 3)$$

$$= (1 \ 4)(2 \ 3) //$$

$$(ii) \beta^{-2} = (7 \ 5 \ 4 \ 2 \ 6 \ 1)(7 \ 5 \ 4 \ 2 \ 6 \ 1) \\ = (1 \ 5 \ 2)(4 \ 6 \ 7)$$

$$\therefore \alpha^2 \beta^{-2} = \left[ (1 \ 5 \ 3)(2 \ 6)(1 \ 5 \ 3)(2 \ 6) \right] (1 \ 5 \ 2)(4 \ 6 \ 7) \\ = \underbrace{[(1 \ 3 \ 5)] \overbrace{(1 \ 5 \ 2)(4 \ 6 \ 7)}^{\text{disjoint}}}_{3 \text{ cycles}}$$

(iii)

$$\gamma^2 \alpha = f$$

$$\gamma^2 \alpha = \beta$$

$$\gamma^2 = \beta \alpha^{-1}$$

$$= (3 \ 5 \ 1)(6 \ 2)(1 \ 6 \ 2 \ 4 \ 5 \ 7)$$

$$\gamma = (2 \ 4 \ 1)(7 \ 3 \ 5) //$$

(5)

$$(i) \alpha = (1 \ 2 \ 3 \ 4)(5 \ 6 \ 7)$$

$$\text{order} = 4 \times 3 = 12$$

$$\beta = (1 \ 7 \ 2 \ 6 \ 4)(5 \ 3)$$

$$\text{order} = 5 \times 2 = 10$$

(ii)

$$\beta^{25} = \overset{(10 \times 2)}{\beta} \cdot \beta^5$$

$$= \left\{ \left[ (1 \ 7 \ 2 \ 6 \ 4)(5 \ 3) \right]^{10} \right\}^2 \beta^5$$

$$= \{1\}^2 \cdot \beta^5 = (1 \ 7 \ 2 \ 6 \ 4)(5 \ 3)^5$$

$$= (5 \ 3)^5$$

$$= \{(5 \ 3)^2\}^2 \cdot (5 \ 3)$$

$$= \{1\}^2 \cdot (5 \ 3)$$

$$= (5 \ 3) //$$

(7) (a)

To prove that an even permutation in the symmetric group  $S_5$  (the group of all permutations of five elements) can be written as a product of 4-cycles, we first need to understand the properties of even permutations and 4-cycles.

1. Even Permutation: A permutation is considered even if it can be expressed as a product of an even number of transpositions. A transposition is a permutation that swaps two elements and leaves the rest unchanged.

2. 4-cycle: A 4-cycle is a permutation that cyclically permutes four elements while leaving the rest unchanged. For example,  $(abcd)$  represents a 4-cycle where  $a$  maps to  $b$ ,  $b$  maps to  $c$ ,  $c$  maps to  $d$ , and  $d$  maps back to  $a$ .

Now, let's prove that any even permutation in  $S_5$  can be written as a product of 4-cycles.

Proof:

Consider an arbitrary even permutation in  $S_5$ . Since it is an even permutation, it can be expressed as a product of an even number of transpositions. We'll aim to show that each transposition can be decomposed into a product of 4-cycles.

Let's consider a transposition  $(xy)$  where  $x$  and  $y$  are distinct elements in the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ . We want to decompose this transposition into a product of 4-cycles.

Case 1:  $x$  and  $y$  are not consecutive elements in the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ .

Without loss of generality, let's assume  $x < y$ . Then the 4-cycle  $(x, a, b, y)$  will swap  $x$  and  $y$  while leaving  $a$  and  $b$  unchanged, where  $a$  and  $b$  are any other two distinct elements in the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ . This 4-cycle can be expressed as:

$$(x, a, b, y) = (x, a)(a, b)(b, y)$$

Note that this 4-cycle will not affect any other element outside of  $\{x, y, a, b\}$ . Thus, we can decompose any transposition  $(xy)$  as a product of 4-cycles when  $x$  and  $y$  are not consecutive.

Case 2:  $x$  and  $y$  are consecutive elements in the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ .

Again, without loss of generality, let's assume  $x = 1$  and  $y = 2$ . Then the 4-cycle  $(1, a, b, 2)$  will swap 1 and 2 while leaving  $a$  and  $b$  unchanged, where  $a$  and  $b$  are any two distinct elements in  $\{3, 4, 5\}$ . This 4-cycle can be expressed as:

$$(1, a, b, 2) = (1, a)(a, b)(b, 2)$$

As before, this 4-cycle will not affect any other element outside of  $\{1, 2, a, b\}$ . Therefore, any transposition  $(xy)$  where  $x$  and  $y$  are consecutive can also be decomposed into a product of 4-cycles.

Since every even permutation in  $S_5$  can be expressed as a product of transpositions, and each transposition can be written as a product of 4-cycles (as shown in the two cases above), we have demonstrated that every even permutation in  $S_5$  can be written as a product of 4-cycles.